

Quad Packing

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Outline

- I. Fundamentals of Quads
- II. The Problem
- III. Results
- IV. Code
- V. Conjectures

What is Quads?

What makes a quad?

Expressions of attributes are all the same, all different, or in pairs.



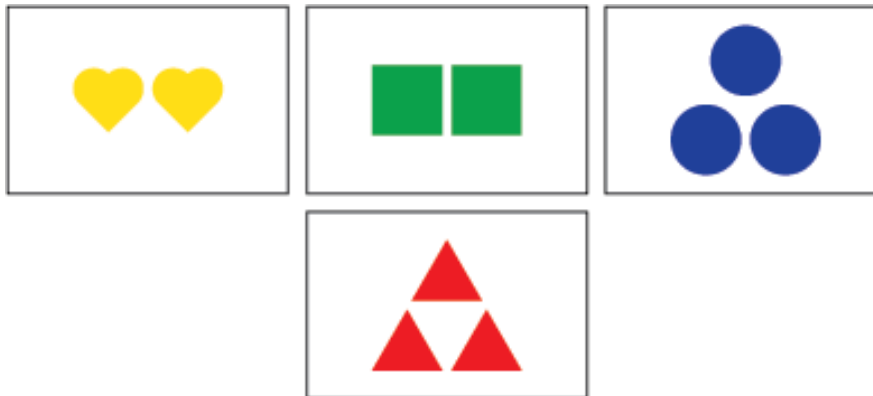
Number is all the same, shape is in pairs, and color is all different

Fundamental Theorem of Quads

For any three cards, there exists a unique fourth that completes a quad.



What card completes the quad?



Vector Representation & Geometry

We can assign vectors in $\mathbb{Z}_2^6$ to each card in Quads by using the following table.

$\mathbb{Z}_2^2$	number	color	shape
(0,0)	1	red	circle
(0,1)	2	yellow	heart
(1,0)	3	green	triangle
(1,1)	4	blue	square

Ex.  = (0,0,1,0,1,1)

Vector Representation & Geometry

Theorem: Distinct cards a, b, c, d are a quad iff $a + b + c + d = 0$.

Corollary: Given cards a, b, c , the card $a + b + c$ completes the quad.

Corollary: $a + b + c + d = 0$

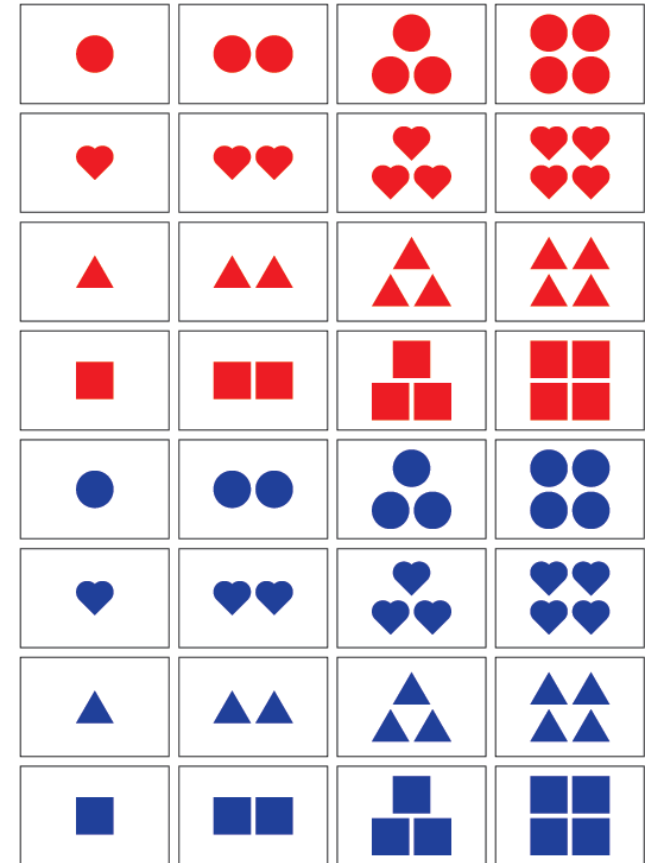
$$a + b + e + f = 0$$

$$c + d + e + f = 0$$

Quad- 2^d

Usually $d = 6$: three attributes with four expressions of each.

Previous theorems hold for any d .



The Problem

In Quad-64, what is the maximum number of quads in k cards?

Alternatively: What is the maximum number of planes that can be made with k points in $\mathbb{Z}_2^6$?

Let $q(k, d) =$ maximum number of quads given k cards in $\mathbb{Z}_2^d$.

Small k

$$q(4, d) = 1$$

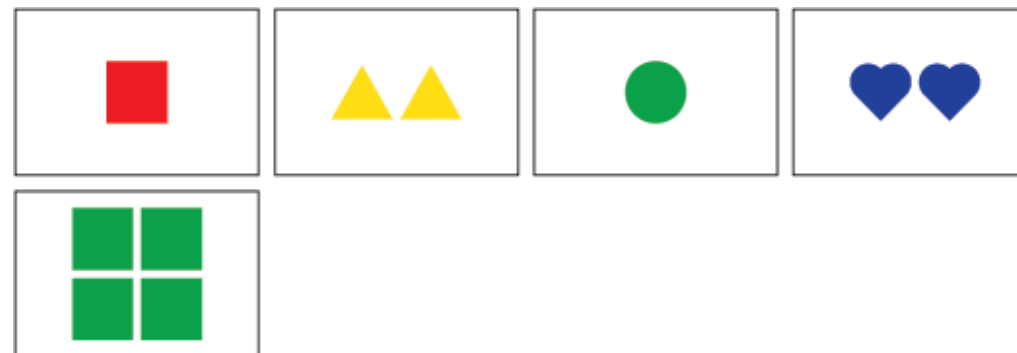
- *Trivial*

$$q(5, d) = 1$$

- *Proof:*
 - By FToQ, $q(5, d) = 1$



4 cards with 1 quad



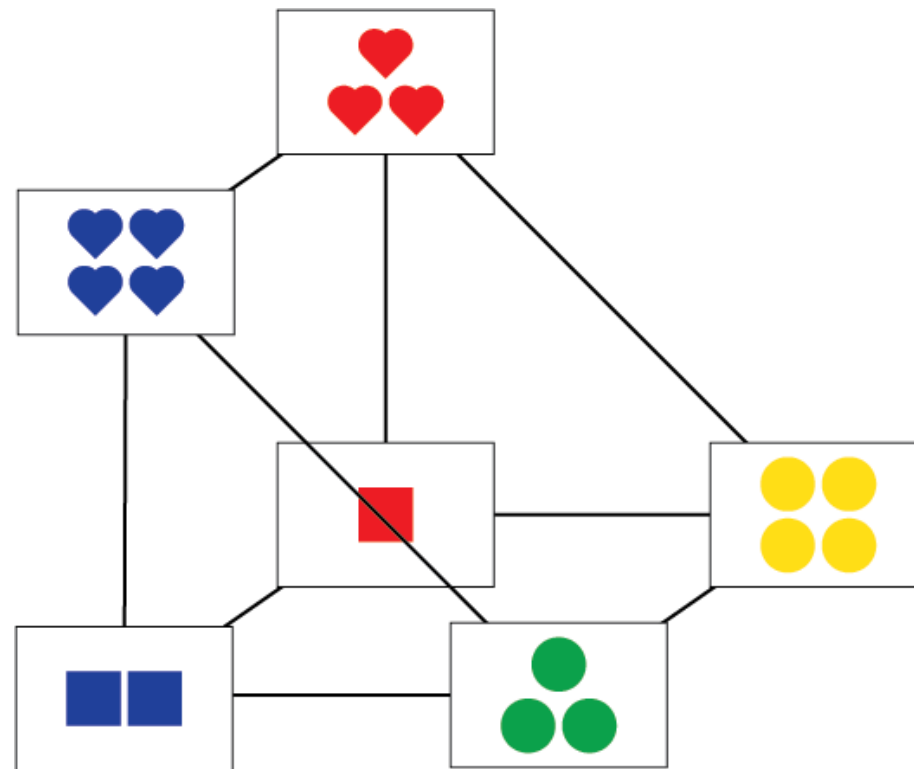
5 cards with 1 quad

Small k

$$q(6, d) = 3$$

◦ *Proof:*

- Form two quads that share two cards, by the corollary this forces a third

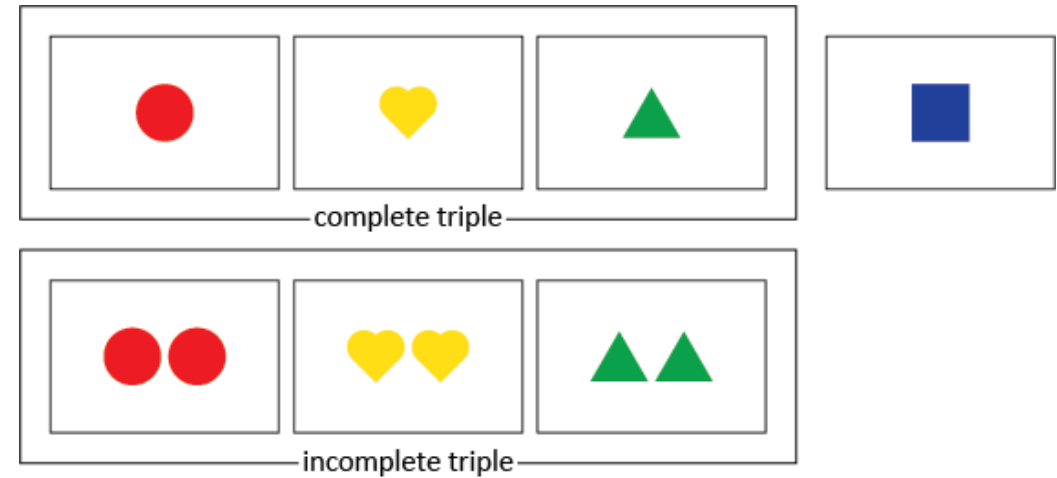


6 cards with 3 quads

An Upper Bound

Statement: For $4 \leq k \leq 2^d$, $q(k, d) \leq \frac{\binom{k}{3}}{4}$.

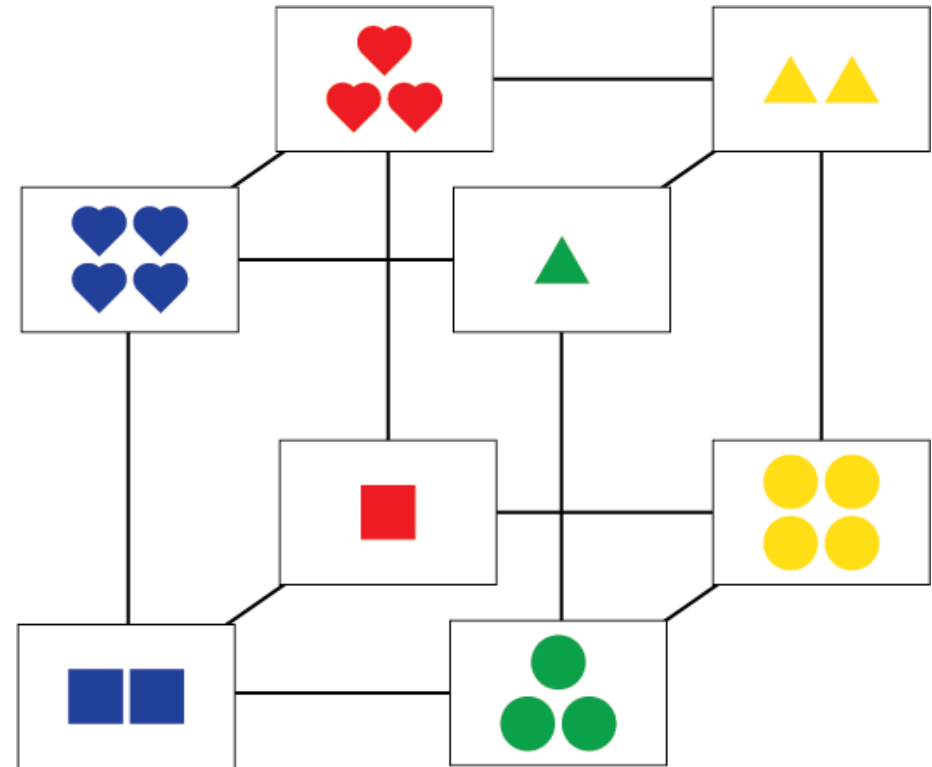
- *Proof:*
- 3 cards = a triple
- Either complete (4 per quad) or incomplete
- At most $\binom{k}{3}$ complete triples, so at most $\frac{\binom{k}{3}}{4}$ quads



Powers of 2

Theorem: For an integer n such that $2 \leq n \leq d$, we have $q(2^n, d) = \frac{\binom{2^n}{3}}{4}$.

- *Proof:*
 - Choose n linearly independent vectors (these exist since $n \leq d$)
 - Linear subspaces are closed under odd sums (counting 0 as an independent vector)
 - Therefore, every triple is complete



A cube of quads cards with 14 quads.

QuadFinder Code

k	d	$q(k,d)$
4	6	1
5	6	1
6	6	3
7	6	7
8	6	14
9	6	14
10	4	18

```
void iterate(int *a, int i, int size, int n, ll &count) {
    int start = 0;
    if (i > 0) {
        start = a[i-1]+1;
    }
    for (a[i] = start; a[i] < size; a[i]++) {
        if (i == n-1) {
            vector<int> subset;
            for (int k = 0; k < n; k++) {
                subset.push_back(a[k]);
            }
            ll curcount = 0;
            for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {
                for (int k = j+1; k < n; k++) {
                    for (int l = k+1; l < n; l++) {
                        int cur = 0;
                        cur ^= subset[j];
                        cur ^= subset[k];
                        cur ^= subset[l];
                        if (cur == 0) {
                            curcount++;
                        }
                        count = max(count, curcount);
                    }
                }
            }
        }
        else {
            iterate(a, i+1, size, n, count);
        }
    }
}
```

QuadFinder Iterate Function

Rohan's Quads Code

- Code written in Rust, original written in C++
- Improved upon original QuadFinder code
 - QuadFinder: looks at every subset of k cards from a deck of 2^n cards
 - Rohan's code: tries to find a subset of k cards from a deck of 2^n cards that has a target number of quads, if one exists; exits the loop if one is found and stores the list of cards
- Also has a function that finds multiple target quads counts
- Allows us to refine best counts instead of performing all computations at once
 - Requires running the code multiple times

Conjectures

- I. For $k \leq 2^d$, we have $q(k, d) = q(k, d + 1)$.
- II. We have $q(2^n + 1, d) = q(2^n, d)$.
- III. We have $q(2^n - 1, d) = q(2^n, d) - \frac{\binom{2^n - 1}{2}}{3}$.
- IV. We can add a card to a maximally packed set of k cards, to get a maximally packed set of $k + 1$ cards.

Based on our results from our code for small k , Conjectures I, II, and III appear to hold.

Conjecture IV was proposed as this is how we were able to find results for $4 \leq k \leq 6$.

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Thank you to the organizers of this meeting and this session!

Links and References

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Thank you!

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Any questions?